

Memorial Day — Year-over-Year Deep Dive

Memorial Day 2025 (Mon May 26) · Memorial Day 2026 (Mon May 25) · Day-of-week aligned comparison

AT A GLANCE

Full-list Send Size	Avg Open Rate (MD window)	Avg Click Rate (MD window)	Campaigns (~3-wk window)	2025	2026	YoY
~219K	~43%	0.40%	25			
~284K	~34%	0.24%	14+*			
^ +31%	v -9 pts	v -40%	~ varies			

* 2026 window not yet closed; 3-4 extension sends queued. All figures for campaigns with analytics available.

1 · List Size & Send Volume

Metric	2025	2026	Notes
Full PC list size	~213K-220K	~283K-285K	List grew ~31% YoY
Segmented sub-sends	None - all sends full list	~68-70K segment for some MD reminders	New in 2026; ~1/4 of full list
Campaigns in ~3-wk window	25	14 (+ 3-4 queued)	2025 window ran through May 31
Double-send days	May 25 + May 26 - 2 emails each	May 26 is the final-day send	2025 used AM/PM splits on key days

The PC audience grew by roughly 31% year over year, which is important context when comparing raw open rates. Actual unique opens per campaign are **broadly stable** — 219K x 42% ≈ 92K opens in 2025 vs 284K x 34% ≈ 97K opens in 2026.

2 · Day-of-Week Aligned Comparison

Memorial Day = Monday. Dates are aligned by day of week, not calendar date.

DOW	2025 Date	2025 Campaign / Subject	OR	2026 Date	2026 Campaign / Subject	OR
Mon -2wk	5/12	PT Reminder: 'Start your week off with savings'	44.3%	5/11	—	—
Tue	5/13	—	—	5/12	Reminder: 'A better room is only \$99 away'	35.6%
Wed	5/14	Designed Reminder (corrected resend) + Editorial: '9 kitchen reno regrets'	94.8%* / 41.2%	5/13	—	—
Thu	5/15	Editorial resend: '9 kitchen reno regrets'	43.8%	5/14	AI feature: 'AI design, backed by real designers'	35.3%
Fri	5/16	PT Reminder: 'Kick off your weekend with savings'	43.8%	5/15	68K seg: 'Big design plans, smaller price tag'	38.1%

Sat	5/17	Editorial: '23 kid + pet-friendly sofas' · SEG HIP reminder	43.0% / 54.7%*	5/16	Full list: 'Nursery goals'	35.5%
Sun	5/18	Editorial: 'Living Rooms We Love'	43.1%	5/17	Full list: 'Your room called - it wants a designer'	36.6%
Mon -1wk	5/19	Designed Reminder: 'Design magic for less than a night out'	42.5%	5/18	Designer feature: 'This is what good design looks like'	34.9%
Tue	5/20	PT Reminder: 'Design packages are HALF OFF'	44.1%	5/19	68K seg: 'A designer-approved summer refresh'	38.3%
Wed	5/21	Editorial: 'This 1970s design trend is BACK'	43.4%	5/20	AI feature: 'One room, three totally different looks'	—
Thu	5/22	Designed: 'Memorial Day deals have arrived - up to 70% off'	42.2%	5/21	68K seg: 'The countdown to your summer refresh is on'	37.1%
Fri	5/23	Designed Reminder: 'What can \$99 get you?'	42.0%	5/22	Full-list PT: '\$99 to transform your space'	33.6%
Sat	5/24	Designed: 'Your dream room is just one click away'	42.4%	5/23	Full list: 'The countdown to your summer refresh is on'	32.1%
Sun	5/25	Designed editorial + PM PT: 'Last chance: Save 50% on design packages'	42.7% / 43.8%	5/24	Full list: 'Stop scrolling. Start designing.'	28.5%
[MD] MON	5/26	AM: 'Design Dreams, Final Hours - 50% Off Ends Tomorrow' PM: 'You are THIS CLOSE to Your Dream Home'	42.1% / 42.6%	5/25	68K engaged seg, STO with 11am local fallback — analytics captured before bulk sends launched+	early+
Tue	5/27	Designed + PM PT: 'Do not let the clock run out - 50% off ends tonight'	41.7% / 43.8%	5/26	Final-day designed (sending today - analytics pending)	—
Wed	5/28	PT Extended: 'Sale extended!'	43.4%	5/27	Extension launch (queued)	—
Thu	5/29	Designed: 'LAST CHANCE - ends at midnight'	41.9%	5/28	Extension final (queued)	—
Fri	5/30	Editorial: 'TRENDING: Nancy Meyers Aesthetic'	43.0%	5/29	DPS AI email (queued)	—
Sat	5/31	Editorial: 'The #1 Pattern Trend Everyone is Trying'	42.8%	—	—	—

* Corrected resend (94.8%) and geo-segmented HIP send (54.7%) are outliers - not representative of full-list performance. + 5/25/2026 send used STO with 11am local fallback; analytics shown reflect an early data pull before the bulk of sends launched. Final send count and OR will be materially higher once STO completes.

3 · Messaging & Content Mix

	Memorial Day 2025	Memorial Day 2026
Sale offer	50% off design services / packages from \$99	Same — 50% off / from \$99
Tone	<i>HALF OFF, Last chance, Final Countdown, LAST CHANCE</i> — high urgency countdown language	<i>A better room is only \$99 away, Big design plans, smaller price tag</i> — aspirational / benefit-led
Editorial interleaving	Heavy — kitchen reno regrets, pet-friendly sofas, 1970s trend, Nancy Meyers, pattern mixing all ran throughout the sale window	Lighter — editorial slots replaced with AI product features + one designer profile
Memorial Day send	2 emails: AM (sale final hours) + PM (you are THIS CLOSE)	Planned final-day email sending today (5/26) — holiday send appears to have misfired at 1,478 sends
Sale extension	Yes — 3 days post-MD (through May 29)	Yes — planned through May 27-28 (+DPS AI on 5/29)

Segmentation	Full list only throughout	Mix: full list + ~68K sub-segment for select reminder sends
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4 · Open Rate Trend — Program-Wide Context

The OR decline in the 2026 Memorial Day window is **not a Memorial Day-specific phenomenon** — it tracks a steady program-wide decline over the past 12 months.

Period	Avg OR (HAV PC email)	Context
May-Jun 2025	~43-44%	Peak engagement period
Jul-Sep 2025	~43%	Stable summer
Oct-Dec 2025	~40-42%	Gradual decline begins
Jan-Mar 2026	~36-38%	Accelerated decline
Apr-May 2026	~33-36%	Current — Memorial Day 2026 window

Unique opens per campaign are largely holding: the list's 31% growth partially offsets the rate decline. A 219K-send campaign at 42% OR produces ~92K opens; a 284K-send campaign at 34% OR produces ~97K opens — a net *increase* in absolute opens.

5 · Click Rate Comparison

Unlike open rates, click rates show a **real, not just proportional, decline** — the difference is largely driven by content mix.

Category	2025 MD window Avg CR	2026 MD window Avg CR	n (2025 / 2026)
Editorial	0.577%	0.200%	6 / 1
Reminder	0.355%	0.279%	12 / 7
Other	0.438%	0.153%	4 / 3
Sale Promo	0.153%	0.260%	3 / 1
Window avg	0.397%	0.239%	25 / 12

The largest contributor to the CR gap is **editorial content interleaving**. In 2025, editorial emails (kitchen reno, pet-friendly sofas, trend round-ups) ran throughout the sale window, averaging 0.58% CR. In 2026 those slots were replaced with AI product feature emails running at 0.12-0.17% CR. Sale promo CR is actually *higher* in 2026 (0.26% vs 0.15%).

6 · Cadence & Timing Summary

	2025	2026
Sale start	~May 12	~May 9-12
Memorial Day sends	2 emails (AM + PM, full list)	5/25: 68K engaged seg via STO (11am local fallback) — analytics captured early, pre-bulk. 5/26: full-list final-day send (analytics pending)
Sale extension	3 days post-MD (through May 29)	Planned May 27-28 (+DPS AI May 29)
Post-MD editorial	Resumed May 30-31	DPS AI email planned May 29
Total campaigns (~3 wks)	~25 campaigns	~14 sent + 3-4 queued
Segmentation	Full list only	Full list + ~68K sub-segment for some reminders

7 · Key Takeaways

- **List grew 31%** — the PC audience is meaningfully larger, which cushions the OR decline in absolute open terms.
- **OR is down ~9 points** — this is a program-wide trend predating Memorial Day, not a campaign-specific issue. It began in earnest in Oct-Nov 2025 and has continued through Q1/Q2 2026.
- **CR is genuinely softer** — editorial content drove high clicks in 2025 (0.5-0.9% for trend/guide emails). Replacing editorial slots with AI product features in 2026 is the primary driver of the CR gap.
- **Sale cadence is structurally similar** — both years featured a ~3-week sale window, daily sends, and a post-Memorial Day extension.
- **Tone shifted from urgency to aspiration** — 2025 leaned on countdown language (HALF OFF, Final Countdown); 2026 is more benefit-focused (\$99 to transform your space, Big design plans, smaller price tag).
- **New in 2026: segmented reminder sends** — three Memorial Day reminder emails went to ~68K rather than the full ~284K. These ran at higher ORs (37-38% vs 33-35% for full list), suggesting better list targeting but lower reach.
- **2026 Memorial Day Day-of send used STO, not a fixed time** — the 5/25 send went to the ~68K engaged segment with Send Time Optimization (11am local fallback). Analytics at time of reporting reflect an early data pull before the bulk of sends launched; final figures will be materially higher. The full-list final-day email sent on 5/26.

Report generated May 26, 2026 · Source: email-knowledgebase YAML archive (~9,200 campaigns) · HAV DPS = Pre-Converted audience (PC campaigns)